(ADB), under Chinese pressure, has turned down Indian requests in the past for financing of projects in Arunachal Pradesh, the Indian state that China claims as its territory. India has sought a greater voice for itself and other developing nations in the Bretton Woods system while also helping to lay the foundations of new institutions like BRICS Bank and AIIB where the developing world might have greater say.

India's position in multilateral institutions, from the United Nations and its specialized agencies to the IFIs, has been consistent since India's independence. India supports multilateralism but it also seeks to reform global agencies, which it feels are influenced heavily by the world's major powers. Seeing itself as a future major power, India has positioned itself as the voice of equity in international bodies, demanding that more powerful nations voluntarily cede some of their power for the sake of greater fairness in international affairs.

GLOBAL DIASPORA, GLOBAL INTERESTS

Part of seeing India as a future great power has been the gradual recognition that India's interests are not limited to its immediate geographic vicinity but are spread all over the globe. India's vast diaspora, from Africa and the Americas to Fiji and Australia, is now considered an asset in exercise of global influence though, unlike some other countries, it is only in recent years that the Indian government has strengthened ties with and tapped into the potential of Indian communities spread all over the world.

Interestingly, the Indian National Congress had passed a resolution as early as 1925 to set up a foreign department that would 'look after the interests of Indians abroad and to carry on educative propaganda in the country regarding their position in the British Empire and foreign countries'. [33] In 1940, the Congress created an Indians Overseas Department.